

OLIVIA WIRTH

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APPOINTMENTS

University of Göttingen 09/2026 – present
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Department of Development Economics, CeMIS

AFFILIATION

University of Passau 03/2026 – present
Affiliated researcher, Chair of Development Economics

EDUCATION

University of Passau 10/2022 – 12/2025
Ph.D. Economics, Chair of Development Economics (summa cum laude) Passau

- Thesis: “Mobile Technologies and Digital Platforms for Development: Essays on Firm Formalization, Financial Inclusion and Agricultural Resilience”
- Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Michael Grimm and Prof. Dr. Stefan Bauernschuster
- DFG Research Training Group: “Digital Platform Ecosystems (DPE)”

The Fletcher School at Tufts University 09/2024 – 11/2024
Visiting Researcher, invited by Prof. Jenny C. Aker Boston

Ludwig Maximilian University 10/2019 – 05/2022
M.Sc. Economics Munich

- Thesis: “Information on Public Spending and the Effect of Reference Points - Evidence from a Representative Survey”
- Semester abroad (DAAD Scholarship): Università della Svizzera italiana, Lugano, Switzerland

Rachel Carson Center for Environment and Society 10/2019 – 08/2022
Environmental Studies Certificate Program Munich

University of Passau 10/2015 – 02/2019
B.A. International Cultural and Business Studies Passau

- Semester abroad (DAAD Scholarship): Universidad del Salvador, Buenos Aires, Argentina

WORK EXPERIENCE

ifo Institute for Economic Research 07/2021 – 04/2022
Research Assistant & Intern: Center for the Economics of Education Munich

Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) 03/2019 – 05/2021
Consultant & Intern: Proklima - Integrated Climate and Ozone Protection Eschborn

ICUnet.Group 11/2015 – 07/2017
Working Student: Customer Relations and Training Management Passau

TEACHING

University of Passau

2023: Growth and Development (Bachelor), Introduction to Quantitative Research Methods for Development (Master), Micro Development Economics (Master)

2025: Seminar in Public Economics (Master)

PUBLICATIONS/ WORKING PAPER

- Aker, J. C., Awonon, J., Grimm, M., Petrik, C., and Wirth, O. (2025). If you build it, will they come? Incentivizing Learning and Networks in Digital Financial Services.
- Dodlova, M., Kis-Katos, K., Kochanova, A., and Wirth, O. (2023). Mobile Technologies and Firm Formalization: Evidence from Uganda (No. wp-2023-99). *World Institute for Development Economic Research (UNU-WIDER)*. **Journal of Development Economics, R & R.**
- Freundl, V., Grewenig, E., Kugler, F., Lergetporer, P., Schüler, R., Wedel, K., Werner, K., Wirth, O. and Woessmann, L. (2022). The ifo Education Survey 2014–2021: A New Dataset on Public Preferences for Education Policy in Germany. *Jahrbücher für Nationalökonomie und Statistik*.
- Hermes, H., Lergetporer, P., Peter, F., Wiederhold, S., Freundl, V., and Wirth, O. (2021). Bewerbungsunterstützung erhöht die Kita-Inanspruchnahme von Kindern aus bildungsferneren Familien. *ifo Schnelldienst*, 74(09), 41-45.

ONGOING FIELD EXPERIMENTS

- Adopting Technology under Climate Stress: Evidence from Randomized Soil Tests and Fertilizer Recommendations (with Edward Asiedu, Michael Grimm, Jann Lay, and Christina Petrik)
- Parched Prospects: Assessing Farmers' Climate Adaptation Strategies in the Wake of a Drought in Northern Ghana (with Christina Petrik, Edward Asiedu, and Jann Lay)

REVIEWING ACTIVITIES

Journal of African Economies

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026:** ERSa Workshop and Public Lecture: Empirical Methods in Competition and Regulation, University of Cape Town, South Africa ◦ Research Seminar Department of Economics, Stellenbosch University (invited talk), South Africa ◦ Nordic Conference in Development Economics, Växjö, Sweden ◦ 5th Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business, Heilbronn, Germany
- 2025:** STEG Annual Conference and Theme Workshops, Oxford, UK ◦ 10. DENeB PhD Workshop on Development Economics, Potsdam, Germany ◦ 39. BGPE Research Workshop, Ingolstadt, Germany ◦ Bavarian PhD Workshop in Development Economics, Erlangen, Germany
- 2024:** 36. BGPE Research Workshop, Munich, Germany ◦ NOVAFRICA Conference on Economic Development, Lisbon, Portugal
- 2023:** European Public Choice Society, Hannover, Germany ◦ International Conference on Development Economics, Paris, France ◦ German Development Economics Conference, Dresden, Germany ◦ UNU-WIDER Author Workshop on Firms and Taxation Using Micro Data from Uganda, Online

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Languages: German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (advanced), French (intermediate), Italian (basic), Portuguese (basic)

IT Skills: MS Office, STATA, R, LaTeX, QGIS, SurveyCTO